THE JOPETNAH FOUNDATION

Child Protection Policy

Building Whole Communities, One Life at a Time.

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Executive Summary

The Jopetnah Foundation (TJF) recognizes that children require special protection due to their age, vulnerability and dependence on adults.

TJF is committed to creating safe environments where children are protected from abuse, exploitation, neglect, violence and any form of harm.

This Child Protection Policy establishes the principles, procedures and responsibilities required to safeguard children involved in TJF programmes, activities and partnerships.

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1. Purpose

This Policy aims to:

- Protect children from harm.
- Prevent child abuse and exploitation.
- Promote child-safe programming.
- Establish reporting and response procedures.
- Define responsibilities for child protection.
- Ensure children’s rights and dignity are respected.

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2. Scope

This Policy applies to:

- Board members.
- Employees.
- Volunteers.
- Interns.
- Consultants.
- Contractors.
- Partners.
- Community volunteers.

It applies to all TJF activities involving children including:

- Education programmes.
- Health initiatives.
- Youth empowerment.
- Community development projects.
- Emergency response activities.
- Research activities.

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3. Definition of a Child

For the purposes of this Policy:

A child refers to any person below the age defined by applicable national laws and international child protection standards.

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4. Child Protection Principles

TJF follows these principles:

Best Interests of the Child

All decisions affecting children must prioritize their safety, wellbeing and development.

Child Dignity and Respect

Children must be treated with:

- Respect.
- Kindness.
- Fairness.
- Understanding.

Do No Harm

Activities must be designed to prevent risks and unintended harm.

Child Participation

Children should be encouraged to express their views in age-appropriate ways.

Non-Discrimination

Every child deserves protection regardless of:

- Gender.
- Disability.
- Background.
- Social status.
- Location.

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5. Types of Child Protection Risks

TJF recognizes risks including:

Physical Abuse

Actions causing physical injury or suffering.

Emotional Abuse

Behaviour causing psychological harm, humiliation or fear.

Sexual Abuse and Exploitation

Any sexual activity involving or targeting children.

Neglect

Failure to provide necessary protection, care or support.

Child Labour Exploitation

Using children in harmful or inappropriate labour.

Online Risks

Including:

- Digital exploitation.
- Unsafe online interactions.
- Misuse of child information.

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6. Child-Safe Programming

All TJF programmes involving children should include:

- Child protection risk assessments.
- Safe activity procedures.
- Appropriate supervision.
- Safe locations.
- Responsible communication practices.

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7. Recruitment and Screening

TJF shall promote child-safe recruitment through:

- Background checks where applicable.
- Reference verification.

- Safeguarding commitments.
- Code of Conduct acceptance.
- Child protection orientation.

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8. Code of Conduct When Working With Children

TJF representatives must:

- Treat children respectfully.
- Maintain professional boundaries.
- Use appropriate language.
- Ensure safe interactions.
- Report concerns immediately.

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9. Prohibited Conduct

TJF representatives must never:

- Harm or abuse children.
- Engage in inappropriate relationships.
- Use children for personal benefit.
- Exchange inappropriate gifts or favours.
- Take or share child images without authorization.
- Ignore child protection concerns.

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10. Photography and Media Protection

Before collecting child images or stories:

TJF must ensure:

- Appropriate consent.
- Child dignity protection.
- Safe use of information.
- Avoidance of harmful representation.

Children should never be portrayed in ways that:

- Humiliate.
- Exploit.
- Endanger them.

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11. Child Participation Standards

When children participate in activities:

TJF shall ensure:

- Age-appropriate communication.
- Safe participation methods.
- Respect for children's opinions.
- Protection from pressure or manipulation.

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12. Reporting Child Protection Concerns

Concerns may include:

- Suspected abuse.
- Unsafe environments.
- Exploitation.
- Neglect.
- Harmful behaviour.

Reports may be made through:

- Child Protection Focal Person.
- Programme leadership.
- Safeguarding channels.
- Emergency reporting mechanisms.

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13. Response Procedures

Upon receiving a concern:

Step 1: Ensure Safety

Immediate protection of the child.

Step 2: Receive Information

Listen respectfully and avoid causing additional harm.

Step 3: Report and Escalate

Notify responsible safeguarding authorities.

Step 4: Provide Support

Connect children and families with appropriate assistance.

Step 5: Document and Learn

Maintain confidential records and improve prevention measures.

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14. Child Protection Focal Person

TJF shall appoint responsible persons to:

- Receive concerns.
- Support programme teams.
- Coordinate responses.
- Promote awareness.

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15. Partner Requirements

Organizations working with TJF children must:

- Adopt child protection standards.
- Train personnel.
- Maintain reporting systems.
- Cooperate with investigations.

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16. Training and Awareness

TJF shall provide training on:

- Child protection principles.
- Recognizing risks.
- Reporting procedures.
- Safe communication.
- Ethical conduct.

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17. Monitoring and Compliance

Indicators may include:

Indicator	Measurement
Child protection training completed	Percentage
Programmes with child risk assessments	Percentage
Child protection concerns addressed	Percentage
Safe programming reviews conducted	Number
Partner compliance assessments	Number

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18. Disciplinary Measures

Violations may result in:

- Investigation.
- Corrective action.
- Suspension.
- Termination.
- Referral to relevant authorities.

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19. Review

This Policy shall be reviewed:

- Every three years.
- Following child protection incidents.
- Following changes in legal requirements.

Conclusion

Children represent the future of every community and deserve the highest level of protection and care.

Through strong child protection practices, The Jopetnah Foundation ensures that children can participate in programmes safely, confidently and with dignity.

> **Protecting children today builds stronger, safer and more empowered communities tomorrow.**